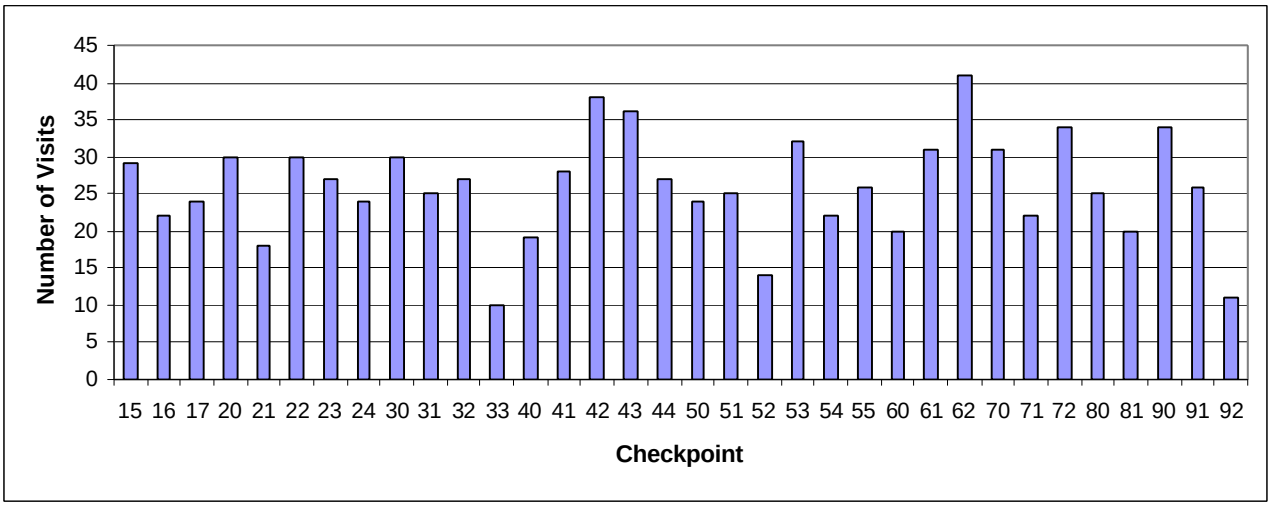
Heights of Korowai (Office Hours) Results
Saturday 29th November 2003

Place	Team No.	Team Members	Points	Elapsed Time (Penalty)	Total Points
1	21	Phil Novis, Ed Rimmer, Chris Forne	1510	6:57	1510
2	34	Desmond O'Regan, Duncan O'Regan	1470	6:52	1470
3	29	Julian Maclaren, Michael Smithson	1380	6:46	1380
4	6	Douglas Woods, Guy de Lacey, Emma de Lacey	1320	6:47	1320
5	23	Mondo Kopua, Zac Hynd	1270	6:44	1270
6	15	Peter Squires, Anne Kennedy, Bill Kennedy	1270	6:53	1270
7	17	Tamsin Page, Ned Norton	1340	7:07(80)	1260
8	36	Rachel Smith, Meg Foulds	1240	6:55	1240
9	1	Alan Holdaway, Richard Holdaway, Robert Holdaway	1200	6:53	1200
10	39	Adrian Heath, Erik Van Eyndhoven	1150	6:49	1150
11	37	Andy Buchanan, John Henry	1150	6:59	1150
12	16	Neil Gard, Kathyryn Newbery	1110	6:52	1110
13	43	Mark Minehan, Mark Chapple	1100	6:56	1100
14	3	Dave Evans, Joy Talbot	1070	6:50	1070
15	33	Emily Wall, Seline Stalder	1060	6:51	1060
16	44	Linda Lilburne, Keith Vincent	1060	6:56	1060
17	10	Daniel Barnfield, Simon Bloomberg, Jacob de Lacey	1030	6:45	1030
18	9	Wayne Millow, Trev Merrifield, Bartie de Graaff	990	6:43	990
19	7	Richard Smith, Linda Smith	980	6:43	980
20	41	Jac Woudberg, Lesley Woudberg	980	6:50	980
21	45	Jeff Mitchell, Sia Svendson	970	6:45	970
22	12	Richard English, Val Rogers	970	6:49	970
23	11	Alan Stow, Kevin Stobbs	960	6:55	960
24	31	Hugo Young, Harry Young, Guy Mulligan	960	6:56	960
25	24	Kerry Ford, Rowan Buxton, David Glenny, Andrew Purves	950	6:48	950
26	35	Mark Elwood, Tony Roger, Alan Dunbar	910	6:47	910
27	30	Jean Cory-Wright, Jan Davies	900	6:43	900
28	42	Philip Wright, Sarah Hebert	870	6:51	870
29	27	Owen Kilgour, Richard Wemyss	870	6:54	870
30	13	Alastair Wall, Amber Sinton	860	6:44	860
31	4	Bruce Meder, Wendy Nelson	840	6:44	840
32	32	Nick Boniface, Mark Botting, Chris Muller	820	6:48	820
33	19	Nicholas Dollin, James Dowle, Mark Dowle, Stefan Lendnal	810	6:49	810
34	14	Ross Barnett, Piers Maclaren	790	6:49	790
35	8	Trish Faulkner, Kathrin Mueller	780	6:41	780
36	25	Tim Jowett, Cody Young	730	6:20	730
37	20	Chrys Horn, Jude Wilson	660	6:53	660
38	22	Lisa Kane, Sue McFadyen	580	6:45	580
39	38	Josie Boland, Bridget Lester	570	6:29	570
40	5	Lisa Pilkington, Pam Whitla, Iona Powell	550	6:44	550
41	46	Richard Suggate, Jesse Taylor	570	7:04(50)	520
42	40	Frances Wall, Jenny Maclaren, Sarah Sinton, Lester Sinton	510	6:51	510
43	28	Sarah Baird, Carl Rathbone	490	6:50	490
44	2	Clive Marsh, Heather North, Ruth Marsh	480	6:42	480
45	18	Allison Thomas, Peter Young	320	6:12	320

Checkpoint Visits



Thoughts from the Organiser, Grant Hunter

A great setting on a gem of a day - fine and clear, a touch of snow from a fall earlier in the week on the background peaks, Lakes Lyndon and Coleridge as blue as blue, and a lightly cooling breeze. That's about as good as it gets. It was a good place to be, whatever the calling. 'Heights of Korowai' rogaine seemed to fit in okay.

Congratulations to the winning team of Chris Forne, Phil Novis and Ed Rimmer with 1510 out of a possible 1570. A perhaps even more remarkable performance was that of father and son team Desmond and Duncan O'Regan with 1470**,** 90 points clear of third place-getters Julian MacLaren and Michael Smithson. My congratulations not only to these teams but all of you. (We'll try to get the winner's route choice up on the web for you.)

With the winning team missing just two low-score checkpoints, the extent of the course relative to the duration was about right. Dave Laurie did a great job allocating the point value to each control, ensuring teams started in all possible directions. This also shows up in the even-ness of control visits (see graph).

I've explained already why some controls were hard to find. The high country landscape is large in scale and open, making navigation relatively easy. If you paused at many places you could see almost exactly where several other controls were located. To compensate I placed some flags close to the ground, the alternative being that they could be seen from far away. Some teams spent many minutes searching in the vicinity, which was NOT my intention, and I regret not getting the degree of visibility quite right. I'll come clean and say that about 11 am, when we learned of these difficulties, we lifted flags 16, 24, 31, 54 and 43 a little to improve their visibility, thus upsetting the 'level playing field' across all teams, but maybe reducing frustration for some. (Hence you should take some relative scores with a grain of salt.)

When bringing in the controls I rechecked one or two that some teams had found problematical. For example, I stand by my description for 32 - SW end of a low faultline ridge. Even Dave Laurie failed to find that one at control-collection time.

I've said before that organising rogaines, too, can be an adventure. New terrain and facilities each time, uncertain timing and clumping of teams finishing, and vagaries of the weather etc. requires a flexible approach. Counting results and getting food out before teams head home is always a

crunch point. This time I discovered the bags of tea, coffee and milo untouched after teams had departed and I imagine the Springfield café profited from that slip. We owe you a cuppa sometime. I thank Bill Kennedy and Dave Laurie for their roles leading towards the event, Tom, Jude, Richie, Anne and Bayne for their help on Saturday, and the backup team from Pegasus SAR.

Keep an eye on www.rogaine.org.nz for other events, but if you're new to map sports think about orienteering – a shorter, sharper event with a funny-coloured map. Peninsula and Plains Orienteers runs events close to Christchurch most fortnights so check them out at www.geocities.com/paponz .

If you're more inclined to tramping, the Torlesse Korowai Park is much larger than the bit you visited on Saturday. It extends over a surprisingly large area, the full length of the Torlesse Range right through to the Benmore Range and our event area west of Lake Lyndon. Email me if you want a descriptive brochure and map of the area or pick one up from a DOC office. See you next time.

Grant Hunter

Pete Squire's Enthuses

This was a real Southern Man event; not for the faint-hearted or unacclimatised Aussies. Hills, steep hills, and lots of them, covered with scree and scrub of all persuasions.

Yet in the middle of all this were some beautiful patches of beech forest, an abundance of sparkling streams with water of thirst-quenching freshness, and some views that stopped even the most ardent competitors in their tracks. The stunning blue of Lake Coleridge 1000 metres below, garnished with sun sparkle and whitecaps, and set in a distant backdrop of snow-covered Alps holding back angry stormclouds makes a unique view. It is so close to our back door yet how often do we see it?

And in spite of the hills, there were some good stretches of enjoyable yet challenging flat country, both plains and alpine streams, nestled in the valleys which helped create the hills.

A 9 am to 4 pm event in mid-summer is an ideal days outing, long enough to want to stop but short enough to ignore the blisters. The 34 checkpoints appeared close on a 14 cm by 12 cm area of a 1:50,000 map, and this gave plenty of interest and plenty of route choice. Right from the start, the 45 teams headed off in many different directions; always a good indication of a well-planned course.

There were the usual perpetual runners, some dedicated hill-walkers, and a good collection of people of more sensible persuasion who had come to enjoy a solid walk in some unique South Island high country. Everyone enjoyed the beautiful day, the spectacular country, and the strategic challenge of such a good course. Grant is to be congratulated for finding such variety in the high country.

Climate-wise, this course could only be used in summer. Even then, there was snow lying on the course two nights before the event, and the road over Porter's Pass was closed on Thursday morning.

I could bore you with What We Did and Why, or What Someone Else Did and Why Not, but I won't. The results explain it all. Suffice to say that the Oldies are getting older and the Young'uns are getting faster!

In spite of its name, no glide time was allowed in this immaculately managed rogaine. It will probably be the forerunner of an annual summer event, judging by its success. Grant Hunter and his able crew have put in a tremendous effort to bring this event to fruition, and they thoroughly deserved the heartfelt thanks led by Trish Faulkner after the prizegiving.

Pete Squires.